The Noble King of Spells of the Drāviḍas

Āryadrāmiḍavidyārāja · Toh 927 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་འགྲོལ་ལྡིང་བའི་རིག་སྔགས་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ།

The Noble King of Spells of the Drāviḍas, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Drāmiḍa Vidyārāja and in Tibetan as Pakpa Drolding Wai Rikngak Kyi Gyalpo, is a short protective spell text, a dhāraṇī or vidyā, in which the Buddha offers safeguarding against the dangers of lightning. Set at Śrāvastī, it opens with the Blessed One addressing the venerable Ānanda and entrusting him with an amulet that averts all lightning, a protection he says was also taught by the fully awakened buddhas of the past. The Buddha then names the lightnings that dwell in each of the four directions, such as Coming in the east and Hundred Voices in the south, and explains that knowing these names brings protection to whoever holds them. This work is Toh 927 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts gathered for recitation and protection.

In the language of India: ārya dvāmiḍā vidyā rājā. In the language of Tibet: The Noble King of Spells of the Drāviḍas.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the courtyard of the Bamboo Shoot enclosure. Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, you must hold this amulet (pratisarā) that averts all lightning. It was taught by the perfectly complete buddhas of the past, and I too now teach it.

"Ānanda, in the east there is a lightning called Coming. Ānanda, in the south there is a lightning called Hundred Voices. Ānanda, in the west there is a lightning called Faded Light. Ānanda, in the north there is a lightning called Lord of the Stream.

"Ānanda, whoever knows the names of these lightnings and knows the directions in which they dwell, it should be known that no fear of lightning will ever arise for them. Wherever these names of the lightnings are written down and placed, no lightning at all will strike in those places."

Then the Blessed One spoke these secret mantra bases of the Drāviḍas:

tadyathā ni mi ni ni mi ni ni mi ni ni mi na dha re Illuminator of the three worlds! Trident-holder, protect me, protect me here in this direction from all lightning! svāhā

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, who had come and was seated in that same assembly, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I too shall utter these secret mantra bases of the Drāviḍas in this Dharma discourse:

tadyathā hate vihate nihate pratyarthike pratyamitre śuddhe mukte vimale prabhāsvare aṇḍāre paṇḍare śvete paṇḍaravāsini harikaradi piṅgalākṣi dantimukhi Protect me, protect me from all untimely death! By the splendor of the noble Avalokiteśvara, may I never see any untimely death! svāhā"

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I too shall utter the words of a dhāraṇī in this Dharma discourse:

tadyathā muni muni muni muni reri mati mati sumati mahāmati hā hā hā hā 'You are free of evil, so do not fear,' says Vajrapāṇi. dṛḍha svāhā

"Blessed One, whoever holds this protection of mine, which no other can overcome, in their heart, or writes it down, I shall protect them always and continuously from all fears. I shall free them from all untimely death."

Then Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I too, for the sake of bringing benefit, help and happiness to all sentient beings, shall utter the secret mantra bases of a dhāraṇī in this Dharma discourse:

tadyathā hili mili cili svāhā prahmasvāre svāre svāhā prahmagarbhapuṣpasaṃstare svāhā

"Blessed One, this protection of mine is called Brahmā's Rod. It fully protects from all untimely death and completely pacifies all evil."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I too shall utter the secret mantra bases of a dhāraṇī in this Dharma discourse:

tadyathā nivarṇī bandha bandha mādanadhe mati mati tiṭi gauri gandhari caṇḍali mataṃgi varalani hīnamadhyamadhāranīmalani dalamatte cakrapakri śapari śapari svāhā

"Venerable Blessed One, this is my spell called the Vajra Thunderbolt. It brings complete liberation from all fears and fully protects from all untimely death."

Then the Great King Dhṛtarāṣṭra, Virūḍhaka, Virūpākṣa, and the Great King Vaiśravaṇa bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we too, for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, and out of compassion for the world, shall utter the secret mantra bases of a dhāraṇī in this Dharma discourse:

tadyathā puṣpe puṣpe dharmavarihari āryapraśaste niramukte maṃgali stute tavite svāhā

"Venerable Blessed One, this protection of us Four Great Kings is called Fearless. It brings fearlessness in the face of all fears, guards life, and fully protects from all untimely death."

Then the nāga king Sāgara, the nāga king Lightning Light, the nāga king Anavatapta, the nāga king Lightning Tongue, and the nāga king Hundred Rays bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we have a great protection called the Wish-Fulfilling Jewel. It averts all lightning, dispels all untimely death, renders poisons harmless, and destroys executioners, sorcery, vetālas and all that is inauspicious. Blessed One, so that we may be lifted out of this nāga birth and may abandon avarice, please, out of loving kindness, accept it. And why? Because, Blessed One, we nāgas have avaricious minds; our minds are wholly bound up by avarice.

tadyathā arje amare amṛte akṣaye puṇyaparyāvate sarvapāpapraśamanāya svāhā āryapuṇyasopakīye svāhā

"Venerable Blessed One, whatever man or woman recites these secret mantra bases with their tongue or writes them down, it should be known that for them there will be no fear of lightning at all.

Whether it be root poison, fang poison, mineral poison, or any other poison arising from the limbs, these poisons will not bring about that person's death. May I be safe from all fears and from all harms."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval, saying "Excellent!" to Śakra, to Brahmā, to the world guardians and to those lords of the nāgas: "Good sirs, you have set out for the benefit of many beings and for the happiness of many beings. In order to uphold this Dharma discourse, you have spoken the secret mantra words of the Drāviḍas. Excellent, excellent! Those in all directions who are asleep, intoxicated or deeply intoxicated will be protected."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, Śakra, Brahmā, those world guardians and those lords of the nāgas, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas rejoiced and praised highly what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble King of Vidyā-Mantras of the Drāviḍas.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, and was then revised according to the new terminology and finalized.

Translator's Notes

- The Tibetan title element 'gro lding is the standard Tibetan rendering of Drāviḍa (Dramiḍa), the South Indian people and region; the spells are presented as "Drāviḍian" mantras. The names of the four lightnings and of three of the nāga kings (Lightning Light, Lightning Tongue, Hundred Rays) could not be identified with confidence as standard Sanskrit names, so their meanings are translated (possibly Vidyutprabha, Vidyujjihva and Śataraśmi, but unconfirmed). "Amulet (pratisarā)" renders so sor 'brang ba.
- The term rendered "mineral poison" is uncertain. The Tibetan word can mean "substance," "essence" or "gem," so the poison may be one derived from a substance or mineral. The other poisons named in the list are clear.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.